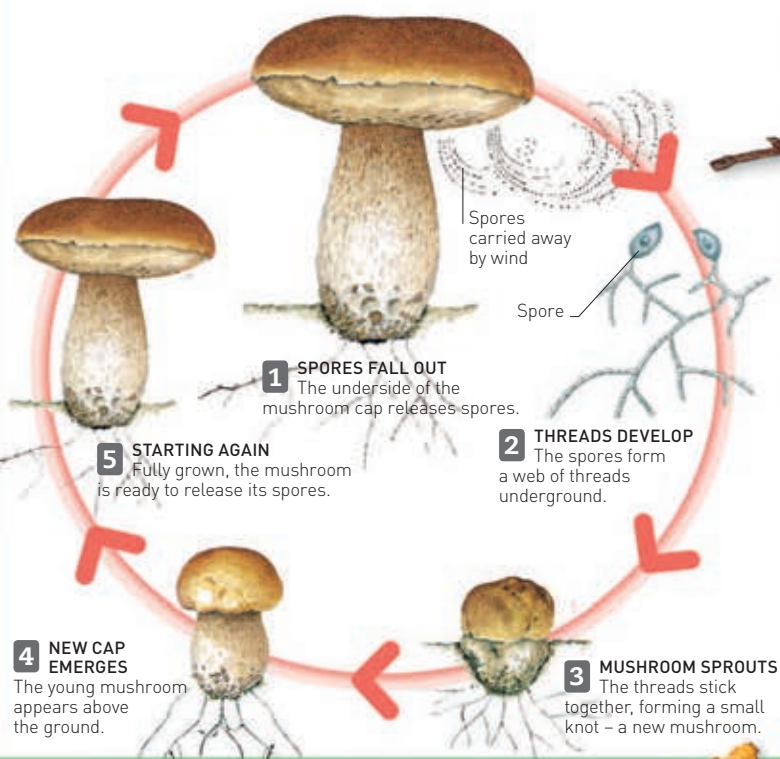


Mushrooms

Although they look like plants, mushrooms are quite different and belong to a separate scientific group – the fungi. They come in many shapes and colours, and all of them feed on organic matter. Some mushrooms are edible but others are deadly poisonous.

LIFECYCLE OF A MUSHROOM

The real growth of a fungus takes place out of sight. Beneath the ground, a web of fine threads develops from the mushroom's spores (reproductive cells) and spreads to produce more mushrooms.



WHERE FUNGI GROW

Finding and identifying fungi means knowing the right places to look. For example, some fungi grow by certain trees.



DANGEROUS MUSHROOMS

Some poisonous mushrooms look very like the ones used in cooking. No one should pick a mushroom without being quite sure what type it is.

DEATHCAP

One of the deadliest fungi in the world, the deathcap can be fatal if eaten.

BROWN ROLLRIM

The poison in the rollrim can damage red blood cells and lead to kidney and liver failure.



JEWELLED AMANITA

This cream-coloured or yellow mushroom can cause sickness and stomach pains less than an hour after being eaten.

FUNERAL BELL

Found on rotting wood, the yellowish-brown funeral bell contains a poison that causes liver damage and, without fast treatment, death.

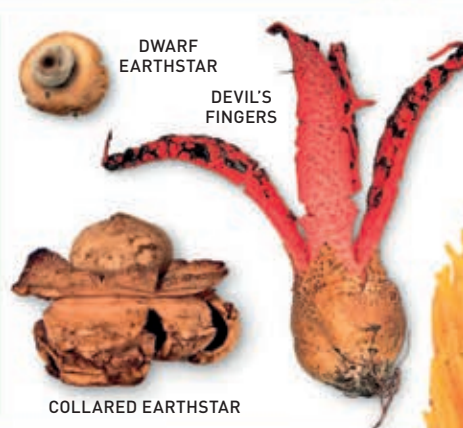
DEADLY WEBCAP

This is very dangerous because it looks like the edible chanterelle mushroom. If eaten, the webcap damages the liver and kidneys.



BRACKET-LIKE

These types of fungi are found on trees or dead wood. They grow like shelves, sometimes forming row on top of row. Bracket fungi can eventually kill living trees by attacking their tissues.



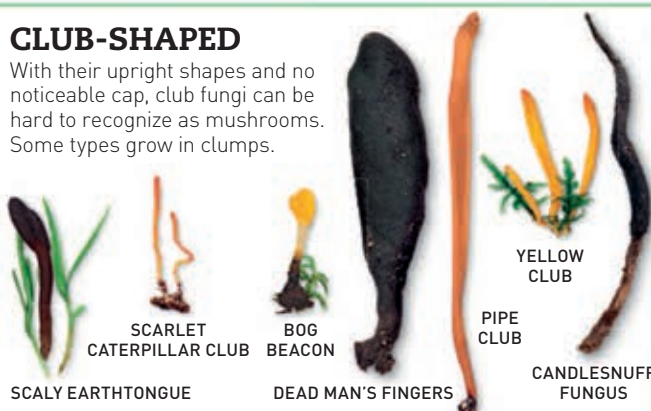
STAR-SHAPED

In these fungi, the spores are held in a round case. To release the spores, the outer layer of the case splits open like a many-pointed star.



CLUB-SHAPED

With their upright shapes and no noticeable cap, club fungi can be hard to recognize as mushrooms. Some types grow in clumps.



CORAL-LIKE

Often brightly coloured, the clustered, branching stalks of coral fungi look very similar to the corals found in tropical seas.

